

Preaching Outline

Key Scripture(s): 2 Corinthians 5: 21, Romans 3:23, Philippians 3:9

I. The Source of our Righteousness - It Comes from Christ, Not Us.

Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:21

- A. Righteousness is not earned - it is received.
 - 1. We cannot achieve righteousness through good works (Romans 3:23)
 - 2. Jesus took our sin and gave us this righteousness.
 - 3. It is a gift of grace, not a reward for performance.
- B. Stop striving to earn what Jesus already finished.

II. The Means of our Righteousness - It is Received by Faith.

Scripture: Romans 3:23

- A. Faith is the hand that receives righteousness.
 - 1. Abraham believed God and it was credited to him as righteousness.
 - 2. Righteousness is imputed (credited to our account).
 - 3. It is not about religious effort but trusting Christ.
- B. Place confidence in Christ's work, not your own record.

III. The Result of our Righteousness - We live from a New Identity.

Scripture: Philippians 3:9

- A. We don't work for righteousness - we work from righteousness.
 - 1. Righteousness changes identity.
 - 2. Identity changes behavior.
 - 3. When you know you are righteous in Christ, you will live boldly, freely, and obediently.
- B. Application Questions:
 - 1. Do you see yourself as forgiven but still "trying", or truly righteous in Christ.
 - 2. Are you living like who God says you are?
- C. Because of Jesus: We are declared righteous.
 - We are made righteous.
 - We are called to live righteously.

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